

Where would you like to take a seat?

Is there a favourite *bench* in your city? Talk about it.



1



2

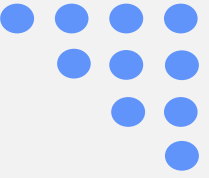


3



How often ____ sit on benches?

How often ____ tired of walking?



How often ...?

always

usually

often

occasionally

rarely

hardly ever

never

most days

once in while

once a month

twice a month

5 times a year

... angry at work?

How often
are you

How often
do you

Work individually.
Choose the right answer:
How often *are you \ do you*



Have a conversation

Find out what your partner **never** does

Have you ever seen these benches?



Who might want to use them?



Most of us spend part of our day surrounded by strangers, perhaps when travelling to work, sitting in a park or a café or visiting the supermarket. We are together with other people, but nobody talks. However, research shows that starting up a conversation with a stranger can make you feel happier and enjoy your day more.

When Allison Owen-Jones saw a man sitting alone on a bench in the park, she wanted to talk to him, but she felt uncomfortable because she wasn't sure he would want to chat. Then she had an idea: 'Happy to chat benches'. She made a sign to put on park benches which said, 'Happy to chat bench. Sit here if you don't mind someone stopping to say hello.' The idea was a success. Now 'Happy to chat benches' can be found in several countries including Canada, the USA, Australia, Switzerland and Ukraine.

So, the next time you see someone sitting alone, give them a smile and say hello. You never know: they might be happy to talk.

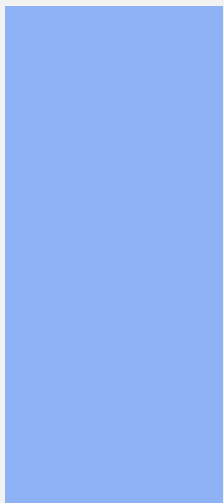
1 Who can sit there?

2 Why did she decide to create such benches?

Over to you

- 1 How often do you talk to people you don't know? In what places?
- 2 Do you like the idea of *small talk*? How do you feel when a stranger starts talking to you?
- 3 Do you think "happy to chat benches" would be a good idea where you live? Why?
- 4 Think of 5 topics that are okay to talk about with strangers.





1



2





**What will you say to
start a conversation?**



Tick the best ideas

- 1 Did you hear about the fire in town? It's terrible.
- 2 That's a nice jacket. Where did you get it?
- 3 Lovely day, isn't it?
- 4 So, who do you think will win the football match?
- 5 It's the *Big Music Live* this weekend. Are you going?
- 6 I heard you have a job in finance. Do you enjoy it?
- 7 We've just got back from Corfu. It was wonderful.

Listen. True or false?

Conversation 1

- 1 The man has never been to the music festival before.
- 2 The woman is going to see a family member at the festival.

Conversation 2

- 3 Kate prefers the coffee from the coffee machine.
- 4 Kate started work two weeks ago.

Conversation 3

- 5 The man is on holiday.
- 6 The woman likes the city.





- *Excuse\Excuse me*, is anyone sitting here?
- No, *go on\go ahead*
- Do you mind if I sit here?
- No, *you're\be* my guest



- Do you mind if I charge my phone here?
 - Go ahead\be my guest\not at all.
-
- Is it okay if I leave my bag here?
 - Go ahead\be my guest\not at all.



- Excuse me, *is there* \ *there is* a café near here?
- Yes, it's on the left.
- Thanks.



- Are you going to a new shopping centre?
 - Yes. What about you?
 - No, sorry.
-
- Is it *your\the* first time here?
 - Yes! I'm so excited.
 - That's my bus. I've got to go. Have fun!



- *Can\Do* I have a cup of coffee?
- Sure! Help yourself.

- How *long\often* have you worked here?
- For 2 years. I'm Alex, *by\on* the way.
-
- Nice talking to you. See you *later\never*!

Excuse me, is anyone (sitting here/using this)?

Is this your first time (here/at this event)?

Do you mind if I/Is it OK if I (charge my phone here/use this)?

How long have you (had your dog/lived here/worked here)?

Are you going (to London/to the festival)?

Excuse me, do you know if there's (wifi/a café near here)?
I'm (name), **by the way**.

OK, nice to meet you.

See you later.

(Great/Nice) **talking to you.**

Have fun./Have a good time.

I've got to go.

That's my (bus/train).

No problem.

Go ahead.

Not at all.

Help yourself.

Be my guest.

What about you?

How about you?

And you?

Sort out

starting a conversation

Do you mind if I charge my phone here?
✓

Is anyone sitting here?
✓

Do you know if there's a cafe near here?
✓

How long have you worked here?
✓

It's a lovely day, isn't it?
✓

Is this your first time here?
✓

reaction/keeping a conversation going

Help yourself.
✓

What/How about you?
✓

Go ahead.
✓

Not at all.
✓

Be my guest.
✓

And you?
✓

I'm George, by the way
✓

ending a conversation

Nice talking to you
✓

Have a good time.
✓

I've got to go.
✓

That's my bus.
✓

See you later.
✓

Ok, nice to meet you.
✓



Think of the phrases that can be used in these situations



Name them
Don't make dialogues



Complete the gaps with 1-3 words

Woman: Excuse me, ¹ sitting here?

Man: No, go ²

Woman: Thanks.

Man: No ³

Woman: Have you been to the festival before?

Man: Yes, I go every year. How ⁴ you?

Woman: Oh, it's my first time.

Kate: I'm Kate, by the ⁵

Justine: Hi, Kate. I'm Justine.

Kate: Great. Well, Justine, I've ⁶ go. Nice to meet you.

Justine: Yes, nice to ⁷

Man: Excuse me, do ⁸ if I charge my phone here?

Woman: Not at all. ⁹ my guest.

Man: Thanks. That's very kind.

Woman: Oh, that's my train. Nice ¹⁰ to you.

Man: Safe journey home!

Listen and check



Woman: Excuse me, ¹..... sitting here?

Man: No, go ²..... .

Woman: Thanks.

Man: No ³..... .

Woman: Have you been to the festival before?

Man: Yes, I go every year. How ⁴..... you?

Woman: Oh, it's my first time.

Kate: I'm Kate, by the ⁵..... .

Justine: Hi, Kate. I'm Justine.

Kate: Great. Well, Justine, I've ⁶..... go. Nice to meet you.

Justine: Yes, nice to ⁷..... .

Man: Excuse me, do ⁸..... if I charge my phone here?

Woman: Not at all. ⁹..... my guest.

Man: Thanks. That's very kind.

Woman: Oh, that's my train. Nice ¹⁰..... to you.

Man: Safe journey home!

Correct answers

Woman: Excuse me, ¹ sitting here?

Man: No, go ²

Woman: Thanks.

Man: No ³

Woman: Have you been to the festival before?

Man: Yes, I go every year. How ⁴ you?

Woman: Oh, it's my first time.

Kate: I'm Kate, by the ⁵

Justine: Hi, Kate. I'm Justine.

Kate: Great. Well, Justine, I've ⁶ go. Nice to meet you.

Justine: Yes, nice to ⁷

Man: Excuse me, do ⁸ if I charge my phone here?

Woman: Not at all. ⁹ my guest.

Man: Thanks. That's very kind.

Woman: Oh, that's my train. Nice ¹⁰ to you.

Man: Safe journey home!

Read conversations

Woman: Excuse me, ¹ sitting here?

Man: No, go ²

Woman: Thanks.

Man: No ³

Woman: Have you been to the festival before?

Man: Yes, I go every year. How ⁴ you?

Woman: Oh, it's my first time.

Kate: I'm Kate, by the ⁵

Justine: Hi, Kate. I'm Justine.

Kate: Great. Well, Justine, I've ⁶ go. Nice to meet you.

Justine: Yes, nice to ⁷

Man: Excuse me, do ⁸ if I charge my phone here?

Woman: Not at all. ⁹ my guest.

Man: Thanks. That's very kind.

Woman: Oh, that's my train. Nice ¹⁰ to you.

Man: Safe journey home!



Can you start a conversation?

